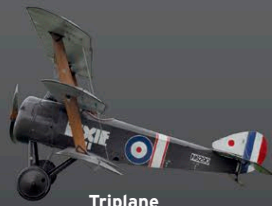




Baby



Triplane



Camel



Snipe

- 1888** Thomas Octave Murdoch Sopwith is born in Kensington, London.
- 1910** Sopwith owns and flies his first airplane, a Howard Wright Monoplane.
- 1911** Awarded Royal Aero Club pilots' license No. 31, Sopwith presents his Howard Wright Biplane to King George V. In the same year he modifies and develops competition aircraft.
- 1912** The Sopwith School of Flying opens at Brooklands, Surrey, and the Sopwith Aviation Company is formed.

- 1913** The company exhibits Britain's first successful flying-boat, the Sopwith Bat Boat and the Sopwith Three-seater.
- 1914** The first Sopwith Tabloid single-seat scout/bomber biplanes are delivered to the RFC and the RNAS. A Tabloid with floats wins the Schneider Trophy race.
- 1915** The single-seat Sopwith Baby joins the RNAS.
- 1916** Two ground-breaking Sopwith designs, the 1½ Strutter bomber and the Pup single-seat fighter, enter service.

- 1917** RNAS Sopwith Triplanes are heavily involved in air combat during World War I. The F1 Camel makes its combat debut.
- 1918** The Snipe and Dolphin are brought into service in World War I and the Sopwith Cuckoo becomes the first British landplane torpedo carrier.
- 1919** The company produces civil aircraft such as the Dove, Gnu, Atlantic, and Wallaby, and diversifies further by producing motorcycles.

- 1920** With no major aircraft orders and a large government excess profits payment demand, the Sopwith Aviation Company goes into voluntary liquidation.
- 1920** H. G. Hawker Engineering, later Hawker Aircraft Limited, is formed by Sopwith, with Harry Hawker and others.
- 1935** The company acquires Armstrong Siddeley to become Hawker Siddeley Aircraft. Sopwith remains a consultant with the company until 1980.
- 1989** Thomas Sopwith dies aged 101.



Competition winner

The Sopwith Tabloid biplane was tested with floats on the Thames River in 1914. A version of this plane won the Schneider Trophy competition in the same year.

“All our airplanes were built **entirely by eye**. They weren't stressed at all.”

SIR THOMAS SOPWITH

with an empty order book and the government demanding a large payment for “excessive profits made during the war,” the Sopwith Aviation Company found itself unable to continue and went into voluntary

liquidation. Thomas Sopwith, Bill Eyre, Fred Sigrist, and Harry Hawker, the inspiration behind many of the Sopwith aircraft, had already set up a new firm to succeed it. Hawker Aircraft Ltd., and subsequently

Hawker Siddeley Aviation, produced a host of legendary aircraft designs including the Fury, Hurricane, Hunter, and Hawk, and pioneered the vertical takeoff and landing Harrier.

Knighted in 1953, Sir Thomas Sopwith was 92 when he stopped working for Hawker Siddeley. He died in January 1989 aged 101, having been at the forefront of aircraft developments for most of his life.

Sopwith Camel

This 1938 magazine cover shows the iconic British World War I fighter, the Sopwith Camel, in a dogfight with a Fokker Triplane.

